



Handout 1.17: Where Does It Go Sort

Name: _____ Date: _____ Team: _____

Part 1: The four zones and the two numbers

Label each zone and write the safe temperature where there is one.

Zone	Temperature	What goes here
Refrigerator	at or below ____ F	
Freezer	at or below ____ F	
Pantry	cool, dry, dark, off the floor	
Counter	room temperature, a day or two	

Inside the refrigerator, raw meat goes on the _____ shelf because _____.

The door of the refrigerator is the _____ spot, so only _____ go there.

Part 2: The sort

Directions: Your team has twelve food cards. Sort them into the four zones. Write each food in its zone. Then do the second sort: mark each food U (use first, within a few days), W (use this week), or M (keeps for months).

Refrigerator	Freezer	Pantry	Counter

The twelve cards: raw ground beef, eggs, bananas, bread, canned beans, milk, frozen peas, cooked rice leftovers, potatoes, an open jar of salsa, a bag of flour, a rotisserie chicken bought today.

One card our team argued about: _____. We put it in _____ because _____.

Part 3: Dates, FIFO, and leftovers

Copy the meaning of each date phrase:

- **Best by:** _____ (about _____, not safety)
- **Use by:** _____ (for raw meat, poultry, fish, and dairy, treat this as the limit)
- **Sell by:** _____ (a note for the _____)

FIFO stands for _____ in, _____ out. When you put a new can on the shelf, it goes _____ the old can, so the old one gets used first.

The two-hour rule: cooked or perishable food goes into the refrigerator within _____ hours of coming off the heat or out of the store (_____ hour if the room is over 90 F). After that, it goes in the trash.

Leftovers: eat within _____ to _____ days. If you will not, _____ them. Label the container with the _____.

Practice: milk says “sell by Tuesday.” It is Wednesday and it smells fine. Safe or not? _____ Why? _____

Practice: leftover pasta sat out from 6 pm to 10 pm. Fridge or trash? _____ Why? _____

Part 4: The waste scenario

A family throws away this every week:

- Half a bag of spinach (the bag cost \$2.99, so half is \$1.50)
- Four slices of bread (the loaf cost \$2.49 and has 20 slices, so four slices are about \$0.50)
- One container of leftovers they forgot about (about \$3.00 of food)

Weekly cost of the waste: \$_____ + \$_____ + \$_____ = \$_____

Yearly cost (times 52): \$_____

That is about _____ dinners at \$40.

Two storage habits that would cut this waste, and why each works:

1. Habit: _____ Why it works: _____
2. Habit: _____ Why it works: _____

Sentence starter: “Our family could _____ so that _____ does not get thrown away.”